
Seri Negara Dialogue 2026

Website User Manual

For the organising team. No technical knowledge assumed.

This manual explains what the website is, what every part of it does, and how to run it yourself — editing content, managing registrations and reading your visitor numbers — without calling a developer.

Public website	serinegaradialogue.org
Admin panel	serinegaradialogue.org/admin

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1. What you have

Two things, on one web address:

The public website	What visitors see. Five pages, four languages, with a registration form.
The admin panel	A private area at <code>/admin</code> where your team edits the site. Only people you give a login to can reach it.

Everything on the public site — the date, the venue, the speakers, the programme — is read from a database that the admin panel edits. **When you save a change in the admin panel, the website shows it immediately.** There is no publishing step and no developer involved.

Registrations from the public form arrive in the admin panel the moment someone submits them, and each person is sent a confirmation email automatically.

2. The public website, page by page

PAGE	ADDRESS	WHAT IT SHOWS
Home	/	The hero banner, the event's date and venue, the concept, a speaker preview and the seats-remaining counter.
About	/about	The dialogue's purpose, the three pillars and the chairman's message.
Speakers	/speakers	Every speaker you have entered — portrait, name, designation, organisation, biography and their official link.
Programme	/programme	The running order, in time order.
Register	/rsvp	The registration form, the seats-remaining meter and the PDPA notice.

Shared by every page: the top navigation, the language switcher, the footer with your contact and social links, and — on phones — a permanent **Register** bar at the bottom of the screen.

The registration form asks for: full name, email, mobile number, organisation, designation, and dietary requirements (the only optional one). Nothing more is collected, by design.

After someone registers they see a confirmation with a reference number and receive the same reference by email. That reference is how you find them later in the admin panel.

3. Signing in to the admin panel

1. Go to **<https://serinegaradialogue.org/admin>**
2. Enter your email address and password.
3. Press **Sign in**.

The eye icon beside the password box shows what you have typed, if you want to check it before pressing enter.

Once in, you will see five sections down the left: **Event, Speakers, Programme, Registrations, Analytics**. On a phone or tablet, tap the menu button at the top left to open the same list.

Signing out: press **Sign out**, at the foot of the left-hand menu. You are also signed out automatically after **two hours** of inactivity — this is deliberate, because the panel shows attendee personal data.

Logins for your team

There is no "forgot password" email. Passwords are issued and reset by whoever administers the server, using a single command. Ask your developer contact to:

- **add a login** for a new team member, or
- **reset a password** for someone who has lost theirs.

Every login has full access — there are no restricted roles. Only give a login to people who should be able to see the full attendee list.

 **Default login — change this before the site is announced.** The site ships with `admin@serineg.com` / `admin@123`. That password is written in the source code, so anyone who can read the code can sign in — and signing in shows every attendee's name, email address and mobile number, which is personal data under the PDPA. Ask your developer contact to create a real login for each person who needs one, and to delete this account. It is one command each. See the checklist at the end of section 12.

4. Event

What this section controls: the date, time, venue and capacity shown everywhere on the site — and whether the registration form is open.

The fields

FIELD	WHAT IT DOES
Date	The real calendar date. Used by search engines and calendar apps.
Start time	The real clock time, picked from a time control.
Date, as written	What visitors actually read — for example <i>8 October 2026</i> .
Time, as written	What visitors actually read — for example <i>2.30 PM onwards</i> .
Venue	The venue's name.
Address	The full postal address.
Google Maps link	Where the "Open in Google Maps" button sends people.
Google Maps embed link	The map shown on the page itself. This one must end in <code>&output=embed</code> .

There are two date fields and two time fields on purpose: one pair is the machine-readable truth, the other is the wording you want visitors to see. **Keep them in agreement.**

The hero — the top of the home page

FIELD	WHAT IT DOES
Event name	The line under the headline. For example <i>Seri Negara Dialogue 2026</i> . Needed in all four languages.
Subtitle	For example <i>A National Conversation on Malaysia's Future</i> . Needed in all four languages.
Background image	The photograph behind the headline.

The background photograph needs to be at least 1600 × 600; around 2400 × 1000 is ideal. Keep the building and the people in the **right two-thirds** — the headline sits over the left third. The preview in the panel marks that left third for you, so you can see before saving whether a face would end up behind the words.

Beneath the preview the panel says which image is in use — *the image that came with the site*, or *an uploaded image*. Once you have uploaded one, a **Use the original again** button appears: it puts the photograph that shipped with the site back, so a hero image can always be undone.

Registration: open or closed

At the top of the Registration box, a coloured panel tells you in plain words what the website is telling visitors *right now*:

IT SAYS	IT MEANS
Open	The form is accepting registrations.
Full	Every seat is taken. The site closed the form on its own.
Closed	Someone on your team closed it by hand.
Past	The event date has gone by.

To close registration early — before a catering or security deadline, say — untick **Accept registrations** and save. Visitors see a closed notice instead of the form. Tick it again to reopen.

A **past** event cannot be reopened with the tickbox, because it is the *date* that makes it past. Change the date if the event has moved.

Capacity

Seats is the total number of places. Below it the panel tells you how many people have registered so far.

- Registration **closes on its own** when the seats are gone — you do not need to watch it.
- You **cannot set capacity below the number already registered**. The system refuses, rather than quietly creating an overbooking.
- Raising the number reopens a full event immediately.

Saving

The save bar sits at the bottom of the screen and follows you as you scroll, so you never have to hunt for it. A message confirms the save at the foot of the screen.

5. Speakers

What this section controls: the Speakers page, and the speaker preview on the home page.

Adding a speaker

1. Press **Add speaker**.
2. Fill in the fields below.
3. Press **Save**.

FIELD	NOTES
Full name	As it should be printed. Names are never translated.
Role	Speaker or Moderator . A moderator is badged as one in the line-up.
Organisation	Their institution or company.
Id	A short code such as <code>sp-09</code> . Set once when you create the speaker; it cannot be changed afterwards. If you are unsure, continue the numbering from the last speaker.
Designation	Their title. Needed in all four languages.
Short biography	A paragraph. Needed in all four languages.
Official external link — Label	What the link is called, e.g. <i>Profile at Universiti Malaya</i> .
Official external link — Address	The web address, starting with <code>https://</code> . Opens in a new tab.
Portrait	See below.
Still a placeholder	Tick while the details are unconfirmed, so the pre-launch check can list them. Untick once the speaker is confirmed.

Portraits

Press the portrait box and choose an image file. It uploads straight away and you will see it appear in place.

- **Accepted formats:** JPEG, PNG or WebP.
- **Shape:** portrait, 5:6 — **700 × 840 pixels** is the target. A square or landscape photo will be cropped and will not look right.
- Use the best-quality original you have; the site optimises it for you.

To remove a photograph, press **Remove photograph** beneath it, then save. The speaker falls back to the grey placeholder until you upload another.

That button only appears once a real photograph has been uploaded. Speakers who still carry one of the stand-in illustrations that came with the site have nothing to remove — replace it by uploading over it.

When a speaker has no photograph, the site shows a plain grey placeholder. It is deliberately colourless so that an unfinished entry is obvious at a glance, on the website as well as in the panel.

The link is optional — leave both boxes blank if a speaker has none. The line-up then shows **No official link yet** in red against that speaker, as a reminder rather than a fault.

Reordering

Use the **Move up** and **Move down** arrows on each row. The order in the admin panel is exactly the order visitors see.

Removing a speaker

Press **Remove** on the speaker's row and confirm. This takes them off the public site immediately and **cannot be undone** — so if a speaker is only *possibly* dropping out, wait for confirmation before removing them.

6. Programme

What this section controls: the Programme page.

Adding a session

1. Press **Add session**.
2. Fill in:

FIELD	NOTES
Start time	Picked from a time control. Visitors see it formatted for their own language.
Id	A short code such as <code>pr-09</code> , lowercase. Fixed once saved.
Session title	Needed in all four languages.
Subtitle	Optional — tick Add a subtitle to reveal it. A panel's topic, for example. If you use it, it is needed in all four languages, or none .

1. Press **Save**.

Reordering

Move up and **Move down**, as with speakers. Sessions display in the order you set here — so keep them in time order.

Removing a session

Press **Remove** on its row and confirm.

7. Registrations

What this section shows: everyone who has registered.

The table lists, for each person: **reference, name and designation, email and mobile, organisation, dietary requirements, and when they registered.**

Finding someone

Type into the **Search** box. It matches name, email, organisation or reference number. Results narrow as you type.

Narrowing by date

Registered from and **to** limit the list to people who registered between those dates — useful for counting the response to a particular announcement. The two pickers bound each other, so you cannot set a range that ends before it begins. **Clear dates** returns to the full list.

Once there is more than one year's event, an **Event** dropdown appears for choosing between them. While there is only the 2026 edition it stays hidden.

If there are many registrations, the list is paged — use the page controls beneath the table.

The red ! beside a reference

It means **the confirmation email did not reach that person.** Their registration is safely recorded — only the email failed. Contact them directly (their email address is in the row) to confirm their place.

Downloading the list

Press **Download CSV.** You get a spreadsheet file that opens in Excel, Numbers or Google Sheets. Use it for name badges, catering numbers, seating and the door list.

The download matches whatever you are looking at — set the dates first and you get only those registrations, not the whole list.

 That file contains names, emails and mobile numbers — personal data under the PDPA. Do not email it around or leave it in a shared folder. See section 10.

8. Analytics

What this section shows: how many people are visiting the site, and from where.

Choose a period at the top — **7, 30 or 90 days**. The panel then shows:

FIGURE	MEANING
Visitors	People who came, counted once per day each.
Page views	Pages opened in total. One visitor may open several.
Registrations	How many registered in that period.
Registered %	The share of visitors who went on to register.

Below the figures: a **bar chart of page views per day**, and breakdowns by **page** (which pages are read), **referrer** (which sites send people to you) and **language** (which of the four languages visitors choose).

What this tells you in practice

- A jump on the day of a press release or a social post tells you it worked.
- A high visitor count with a low **Registered %** suggests the registration page or the form is the obstacle, not the publicity.
- The **language** breakdown tells you which translations are actually being read — useful when deciding where to spend on printed material.

Why there is no Google Analytics

The site counts its own visitors. **No cookies are set, nothing is sent to any outside company, and no cookie-consent banner is needed** — that is a direct consequence of the choice, not an oversight. No IP addresses are stored, and nothing identifies an individual. It costs nothing and there is no subscription to renew.

The honest limit of this approach: you get daily unique visitor counts, not a history of any individual's visits. If Google Analytics is ever required, please raise it first — it would mean third-party cookies, attendee browsing data leaving the country, and a consent banner to design and translate into four languages.

9. The four languages

The site is published in **English, Bahasa Malaysia, 中文 and தமிழ்**. Visitors switch with the control in the header, and their choice is remembered.

What this means when you edit: any field marked as needing all four languages — speaker designations and biographies, session titles and subtitles — must be filled in for all four, or the save will be refused. This is deliberate: it is what stops one language quietly falling out of step with the others.

If you do not yet have a translation, put the English in temporarily and replace it — an untranslated field is visible, a missing one is broken.

The site's *fixed* wording — headings, buttons, form labels, the PDPA notice — is not edited in the admin panel. Changes to that wording go through your developer contact.

Note: the 中文 and தமிழ் versions of the fixed wording are currently machine-translated and **still need a native speaker's review** before launch.

10. Privacy and attendee data (PDPA)

The registration list is personal data. Please treat it accordingly.

What the system does for you:

- The registration form collects only what is genuinely needed — six fields, one of them optional.
- Attendee data is reachable only behind an admin login.
- The application's passwords and database credentials sit outside the public area of the server and cannot be downloaded.
- The form is rate-limited, so a script cannot work through a list of addresses.
- Analytics stores nothing identifying — no IP addresses, no visitor histories.
- "Do Not Track" browser settings are honoured.

What is your responsibility:

- Keep the number of people with admin logins small.
- Treat the CSV export as confidential once it leaves the panel.
- Have the **PDPA notice on the registration page signed off** by whoever is accountable for the data, before the site is announced.
- Delete the registration data once it is no longer needed after the event.
- Clear analytics rows older than a year once the 2026 edition is closed out (ask your developer contact — it is one command).

11. Everyday questions and problems

"I saved, but the website has not changed." Refresh the page in your browser (Ctrl+R, or Cmd+R on a Mac). If it still looks old, try a private/incognito window — what you are seeing is your own browser's cached copy.

"It says my change could not be saved." The panel tells you which field is wrong, beside that field. The usual causes: a language left blank in a four-language field, a link that does not start with `https://`, or a capacity set below the number already registered.

"It says it cannot reach the server." The website is temporarily unreachable. Press **Try again**. If it persists for more than a few minutes, contact your developer.

"Someone says they registered but got no email." Look them up in Registrations. If a red ! shows beside their reference, their registration is recorded and only the email failed — reply to them directly with their reference number.

"We need to cancel or postpone." Untick **Accept registrations** in Event to close the form at once, then change the date. Use the CSV export to email everyone already registered.

"The seats counter looks wrong." It is the capacity minus the number registered, live. If it reads zero, the event is full and the form has closed itself — raise **Seats** to reopen it.

"I have forgotten my password." There is no reset email. Contact your developer, who can issue a new one.

12. What belongs to you

On handover, the following transfer to Chevening Alumni Malaysia:

- The domain name **serinegaradialogue.org**
- The hosting account
- The source code repository
- The database, including every registration
- Every admin login

There are no plugin licences, paid subscriptions or third-party services to renew — the site was built so that running it costs the hosting and the domain, and nothing else.

Before the site is announced

A short list, all of it for your developer contact rather than for you, but worth checking has been done:

- ☐ **Replace the default admin login.** A real account for each person who needs one, and `admin@serineg.com` deleted. Nothing else on this list matters as much.
- ☐ Real speaker photographs and names in place of the stand-ins.
- ☐ The PDPA wording on the registration form approved by whoever is accountable for attendee data.
- ☐ The Chinese and Tamil translations read by a native speaker.
- ☐ Search engines allowed in — the site blocks them until launch, on purpose, so half-finished pages are never indexed.

Adding the 2027 edition

The site was built to be reused. A second edition does not need a new website — the year's content is a self-contained set that your developer copies forward. Ask for it when the time comes; it is a short job, not a rebuild.

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